Benjamin Parry

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I've built products, written policy, and filled lecture halls. In each case my work has focused on making complex things clear to people who need to act on them. I run **The Toronto Society for the Diffusion of Useful Knowledge.** An experiment in education and research for the next 100 years of human flourishing. Previously, I co-founded and led policy at **Build Canada** where I wrote and edited policy recommendations that were read widely within the Canadian federal government and helped shape the future of billions of dollars of spending. Before that I worked at Tim Hortons where I designed, built and ran the largest loyalty program in Canada including setting up the organization's data science team.

Professional Experience

The Toronto Society *for the* Diffusion *of* Useful Knowledge

Founder

Toronto, ON | March 2024 — Present

• Brought together 2000 people for 10 lectures with The Viaduct on topics from economics and history to psychology and philosophy

• Ran reading groups, roundtables, debates and more to create a space described as “the best intellectual community in Toronto”

Build Canada

Co-Founder Head of Policy

Toronto, ON | December 2024 — February 2026

• Created and ran an LLM process driven by meaningful human input to help turn entrepreneur ideas into detailed, actionable policy memos

• Developed internal processes for community management, events and social media content creation

Restaurant Brands International (Tim Hortons)

Director Strategy and Operations

Toronto, ON | June 2018 — March 2024

• Developed the strategy for Tims Financial, ran negotiations with all of Canada’s top banks and developed the initial product and team

• Created the company’s data science team to run forecasting, supply chain optimization and drive decision making on $20m+ of sales

• Led a cross-functional team to develop Tim Hortons first loyalty program and grew it to 10 million weekly active users

Ritual

Analyst

Toronto, ON | February 2018 — May 2018

• Designed and ran processes to onboard restaurants as new merchants on the Ritual platform

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Education

University of Pennsylvania

Bachelor of Arts and Sciences: East Asian Languages and Civilization Honours Student

Philadelphia, PA | Graduated: May 2016

In my final year I was a Dean’s scholar with a 4.0 GPA. My honour’s thesis for my major looked at why Buddhism became vegetarian as it migrated from India to China. Since university I have continued self-directed learning focussing my time on economics, complexity science, statistics, philosophy, and religious studies.

Skills and Interests

Technical: I know enough about data analysis with Python and SQL as well as Web Development (HTML, CSS, JS) to be supercharged by Claude, though not enough to review production code.

Other: Conversational Mandarin 🇨🇳

I run an intermittent research project called Skillful Notes looking at how people, organizations, and societies become competent